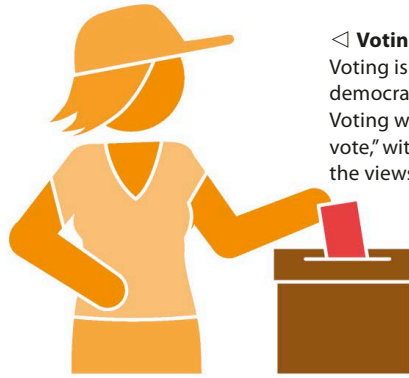


Citizen actions

Active citizens appreciate their freedoms and take their responsibilities seriously. Many aspects of citizenship produce a sense of pride and belonging. Singing a country's national anthem in public, for instance, inspires a sense of unity among citizens, and celebrating national holidays is also a way for citizens to honor the events and people that shaped their country.

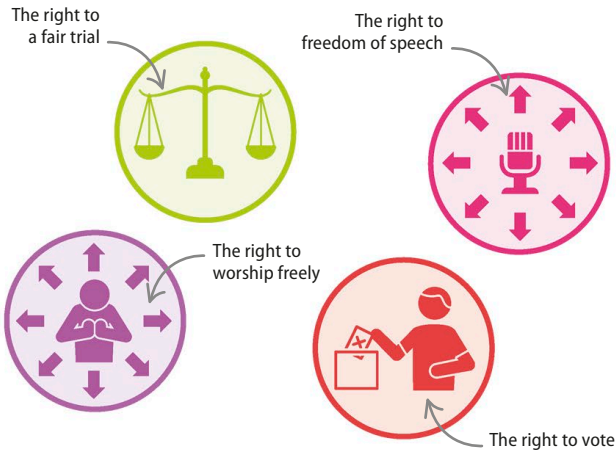


◁ Voting

Voting is both a right and a responsibility in democratic societies for people above a certain age. Voting works on the principle of “one person, one vote,” with the resulting government representing the views and beliefs of the majority of voters.

Citizen rights

A country's Bill of Rights is a formal declaration of legal and civil rights—such as the rights to vote and worship freely, the right to a fair trial, and freedom of speech. These rights and freedoms are granted to all citizens, but can be taken away if a person breaks their part of the citizenship deal, such as by committing a crime.



GOOD TO KNOW

Universal Declaration of Human Rights

In 1948, the United Nations (UN) adopted the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, which aims to secure basic citizenship rights—such as the right to life, liberty, and security—for every individual in the world. Despite international support of the declaration, there is still neglect and abuse of human rights in many countries around the world.

Laws of a country

Most laws are based on the basic rule of “doing the right thing,” and all citizens must abide by these laws. Some countries' laws follow religious law, too.

Each country has lots of citizens, and they all need to get along and behave in respectful ways in order for society to function. Laws spell out what behavior is acceptable. Some laws are the same across the world—for example, in every country, murder is considered a crime. Most countries constantly scrutinize their laws to ensure they are fair and appropriate to and for all citizens.

▽ The scope of the law

Laws strive to ensure fairness and order across all aspects of society. In many countries, dropping litter is an offense.

